STUDY AID · MATTHEW 25:1-30 · EPISODE 48 (#51 OF 58 IN THE PLAYLIST)

Lamps Lit, *Talents Traded*

Keep the flame burning

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 25:1-30 in the LSB | 32:11 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: This Parable Exposes False Faith and True Faith. Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 25:1-30. Ten virgins go out with lamps to meet the bridegroom; five foolish take no oil, five prudent take flasks. The bridegroom is delayed, they sleep, and at midnight the shout comes. The foolish run to buy oil, the door is shut, and the bridegroom says, 'I do not know you.' Then a man going on a journey hands his slaves five talents, two and one. Two trade and double them; the third buries his. The master returns, praises the faithful, and throws the worthless slave into the outer darkness.
- These parables still answer the disciples' question about the temple (24:3). The virgins are bridesmaids in a wedding procession that lit the way to the bridegroom's banquet. The foolish did not simply forget; they refused to care about their role.
- The video reads the numbers symbolically (five pointing to the Torah) and reads the wedding as covenant: God remembers Israel's 'love of your betrothals' (Jeremiah 2:2) and was 'a husband to them' (Jeremiah 31:32). In the temple the priests kept the lamp burning continually with clear olive oil (Exodus 27:20-21; Leviticus 24:2-4).
- The talents recall Josiah's temple repair, where money went to craftsmen, builders and masons and 'no accounting shall be made with them' (2 Kings 22:4-7). Jesus flips it: each slave must give an account. Lamps and talents set bridesmaids and servants inside the world of the temple and its priests.

> *"The kingdom of heaven will continue to spread even after the Jewish temple is destroyed because Jesus' disciples will faithfully maintain God's eternal presence with his people and they will increase the magnitude of his true temple.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"Being caught like this without oil is not evidence of a sincere mistake or a last second accident.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

- The lesson: the kingdom of heaven will continue to spread even after the Jewish temple is destroyed, because Jesus' disciples will faithfully maintain God's eternal presence with His people and increase the magnitude of His true temple, a temple of living stones (Ephesians 2:19-22; 1 Peter 2:4-6).

Ask what it recalls

For each image in a parable (lamps, oil, money, an accounting), ask where the Old Testament has used it before.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB. This is Episode 48 of the Matthew study (playlist item 51).

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 25:1-30 and turns to Matthew 7 and 24, Luke 19, Zechariah 8, Jeremiah 2 and 31, Exodus 27, Leviticus 24, 2 Kings 22, Ephesians 2, 1 Peter 2 and Isaiah 28. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 25:1-30
Read in full: the ten virgins and the talents.

Matthew 24:3
The question the parables still answer.

Matthew 7:21-23
'Lord, Lord' and 'I never knew you.'

Luke 19:11-27
The parable of the minas.

Zechariah 8:23
Ten men take hold of the garment of a Jew.

Jeremiah 2:2
The love of your betrothals.

Jeremiah 31:31-32
A new covenant; I was a husband to them.

Exodus 27:20-21
A lamp burning continually.

Leviticus 24:2-4
The lamps on the pure gold lampstand.

2 Kings 22:3-7
Josiah's money for the temple repair.

Ephesians 2:19-22
A holy sanctuary in the Lord.

1 Peter 2:4-6
Living stones, a spiritual house.

Isaiah 28:16
A costly cornerstone in Zion.

Key verses in the LSB

“Therefore, stay awake, for you do not know the day nor the hour.”
Matthew 25:13 (LSB)

“Well done, good and faithful slave. You were faithful with a few things, I will put you in charge of many things; enter into the joy of your master.”
Matthew 25:21 (LSB)

“you also, as living stones, are being built up as a spiritual house for a holy priesthood, to offer up spiritual sacrifices acceptable to God through Jesus Christ.”
1 Peter 2:5 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The ten virgins

Bridesmaids, oil, and a shut door.



MATTHEW 25:1-5

Bridesmaids with lamps

MATTHEW 25:1-4 (LSB)

THE PROCESSION

““Then the kingdom of heaven may be compared to ten virgins, who took their lamps and went out to meet the bridegroom. Now five of them were foolish, and five were prudent. For when the foolish took their lamps, they took no oil with them, but the prudent took oil in flasks along with their lamps.”

FROM THE VIDEO 'Virgins' marks their role at a wedding: young unmarried women attending the bride. The video cites a commentator: after the vows, the couple walked from the bride's home to the bridegroom's, where a banquet waited; at night, torches lit the way.

FROM THE VIDEO The parables give pictures of the same event the disciples asked about, the destruction of the temple, to fill in more and to teach them.

◆ Factbook: Bridegroom ◆ Factbook: Marriage ◆ Factbook: Parable



MATTHEW 25:6-10

Our lamps are going out

MATTHEW 25:8-10 (LSB)

OIL

“And the foolish said to the prudent, ‘Give us some of your oil, for our lamps are going out.’ But the prudent answered, saying, ‘No, there will not be enough for us and you too; go instead to the dealers

and buy some for yourselves.’ And while they were going away to make the purchase, the bridegroom came, and those who were ready went in with him to the wedding feast; and the door was shut.”

FROM THE VIDEO The difference is intentionality. Those who took no oil did not care about the role and responsibility of a bridesmaid: they were supposed to keep the fire in their lamps from going out.

FROM THE VIDEO The video reads the numbers as symbols: five points to the Torah, and ten recalls Zechariah 8:23, 'ten men from every tongue of the nations.' **Zechariah 8:23**

◆ Factbook: Lampstand ◆ Factbook: Gematria

MATTHEW 25:11-13; 7:21-23

'I do not know you'

THE BRIDEGROOM · MATTHEW 25:11-12

“And later the other virgins also *came, saying, ‘Lord, lord, open up for us.’ But he answered and said, ‘Truly I say to you, I do not know you.’”

JESUS, EARLIER · MATTHEW 7:21

““Not everyone who says to Me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ will enter the kingdom of heaven, but he who does the will of My Father who is in heaven will enter.”

FROM THE VIDEO At a normal wedding, latecomers would probably be let in. In the parable the door stays shut, and the words echo the Sermon on the Mount: 'I never knew you' (7:23). **Matthew 7:23**

◆ Factbook: Sermon on the Mount ◆ Factbook: Kingdom of heaven



The prudent took oil in flasks

James Tissot, The Wise Virgins, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain



Our lamps are going out

James Tissot, The Foolish Virgins, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *“Being caught like this without oil is not evidence of a sincere mistake or a last second accident.*
>
> From the video

The wedding and the temple lamp

Covenant as marriage, the lampstand, and living stones.

JEREMIAH 2:2; 31:31-32

The wedding is a covenant

JEREMIAH · JEREMIAH 2:2

““Go and call out in the ears of Jerusalem, saying, ‘Thus says Yahweh, / “I remember concerning you the lovingkindness of your youth, / The love of your betrothals, / Your walking after Me in the wilderness, / Through a land not sown.”

JEREMIAH · JEREMIAH 31:32

“not like the covenant which I cut with their fathers in the day I took them by the hand to bring them out of the land of Egypt, My covenant which they broke, but I was a husband to them,” declares Yahweh.”

FROM THE VIDEO Weddings and covenants are interchangeable images. The messianic age would bring all nations together (Isaiah 9; Micah 4; Zechariah 8) and a new covenant (Jeremiah 31; Ezekiel 36). **Jeremiah 31:31**

FROM THE VIDEO A covenant means knowing God, which requires His presence; that is why the temple was built and the ark of the covenant placed in the holy of holies.

◆ Factbook: New covenant ◆ Factbook: Jeremiah (prophet) ◆ Factbook: Messianic banquet

EXODUS 27:20-21; LEVITICUS 24:2-4

A lamp burning continually

EXODUS · EXODUS 27:20-21

““And you shall command the sons of Israel, that they bring you clear oil of beaten olives for the light, to make a lamp burn continually. In the tent of meeting, outside the veil which is before the testimony, Aaron and his sons shall keep it in order from evening to morning before Yahweh; it shall be a perpetual statute throughout their generations for the sons of Israel.”

LEVITICUS · LEVITICUS 24:4

“He shall keep the lamps in order on the pure gold lampstand before Yahweh continually.”

FROM THE VIDEO The seven-branched lampstand stood for God's presence, and the priests tended its oil so the light would not go out. Careless, corrupt priests are like bridesmaids who let their lamps go out, and they will be replaced.

◆ Factbook: Lampstand ◆ Factbook: Aaron ◆ Factbook: Priest ◆ Factbook: Tabernacle

EPHESIANS 2:19-22; 1 PETER 2:4-6

Living stones

PAUL · EPHESIANS 2:20-21

“having been built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Christ Jesus Himself being the corner stone, in whom the whole building, being joined

PETER · 1 PETER 2:5

“you also, as living stones, are being built up as a spiritual house for a holy priesthood, to offer up spiritual sacrifices acceptable to God through Jesus Christ.”

together, is growing into a holy sanctuary in the Lord,”

FROM THE VIDEO The disciples got the message: they would be both priests and the temple of God in the messianic age, both bridesmaid and bride, both the builder and the built.

FROM THE VIDEO Peter roots it in Isaiah 28:16: 'Behold, I am laying in Zion a stone, a tested stone.' **Isaiah 28:16**

◆ Factbook: Cornerstone ◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish) ◆ Factbook: Paul ◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter)

> *“Weddings and covenants are so complementary to each other in the Bible that they become interchangeable images in the minds of the Jews.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The talents

Five, two and one; Josiah's repair; the outer darkness.



MATTHEW 25:14-18

Five, two and one

💰 MATTHEW 25:14-15 (LSB) TALENTS

““For it is just like a man about to go on a journey, who called his own slaves and handed over his possessions to them. And to one he gave five talents, to another, two, and to another, one, each according to his own ability; and he went on his journey.”

FROM THE VIDEO A talent was an enormous weight of silver, like the old $10,000 bill: the story is about wealth. In 25:18 the hidden talent is called 'money.'

FROM THE VIDEO Luke's parable of the minas is similar but tells a different story (Luke 19:11-27). **Luke 19:11-27**

BACKGROUND A silver talent was about 6,000 denarii, roughly twenty years' wages for a laborer.

◆ Factbook: Talent ◆ Factbook: Denarius



2 KINGS 22:4-7

Josiah's temple repair

🔨 2 KINGS 22:5-7 (LSB) AN ACCOUNTING

“And let them give it into the hand of those who do the work, who have the oversight of the house of Yahweh, and let them give it to those who do the work, who are in the house of Yahweh, to repair the damages of the house, to the craftsmen and the builders and the masons and for buying timber and hewn stone to repair the house. Only no accounting shall be made with them for the money given into their hands, for they deal faithfully.””

FROM THE VIDEO The temple had been neglected and desecrated by the kings before Josiah, his grandfather in particular. Josiah gives money to three kinds of workers to repair it.

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus flips verse 7: each slave must give an account of the master's money. The picture is of servants using money meant to restore a desecrated temple.

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish) ◆ Factbook: Priest

MATTHEW 25:24-30

The worthless slave

MATTHEW 25:29-30 (LSB)

OUTER DARKNESS

““For to everyone who has, more shall be given, and he will have an abundance; but from the one who does not have, even what he does have shall be taken away. And throw out the worthless slave into the outer darkness; in that place there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.”

FROM THE VIDEO The same end as the evil slave in 24:51, the sons of the kingdom in 8:12, the lawless in 13:42, the evil in 13:50 and the guest without wedding clothes in 22:13. Matthew 24:51 Matthew 8:12 Matthew 22:13

BACKGROUND 'You ought to have put my money in the bank' (25:27): even the least risky use would have shown some faithfulness.

◆ Factbook: Outer darkness



Settling accounts

Willem de Poorter, The Parable of the Talents, 17th century. Via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *“The physical stones of the earthly temple will be replaced with the living stones of God's true temple.*
>
> From the video

Who's who in 25:1-30

What the video says, then a short background note.

The ten virgins

VIDEO Bridesmaids in the wedding procession; five ready, five not.

BACKGROUND They wait at night, so the bridegroom's coming is unexpected.

Matthew 25:1-13

The bridegroom

VIDEO The awaited figure whose coming opens and shuts the door.

BACKGROUND Jesus calls Himself the bridegroom in 9:15.

Matthew 9:15 · Matthew 25:10 · ◆ Bridegroom

The three slaves

VIDEO Entrusted with five, two and one talents; each must give an account.

BACKGROUND The third calls the master 'a hard man' and is judged by his own words.

Matthew 25:14-30 · ◆ Talent · ◆ Talents and Minas (Parables)

Josiah

VIDEO King who repaired the neglected temple.

BACKGROUND During the repair Hilkiah found the book of the law (2 Kings 22:8).

2 Kings 22:1-8 · ◆ Josiah · ◆ Hilkiah · ◆ Manasseh (king of Judah)

Aaron and his sons

VIDEO Priests charged to keep the lamp burning.

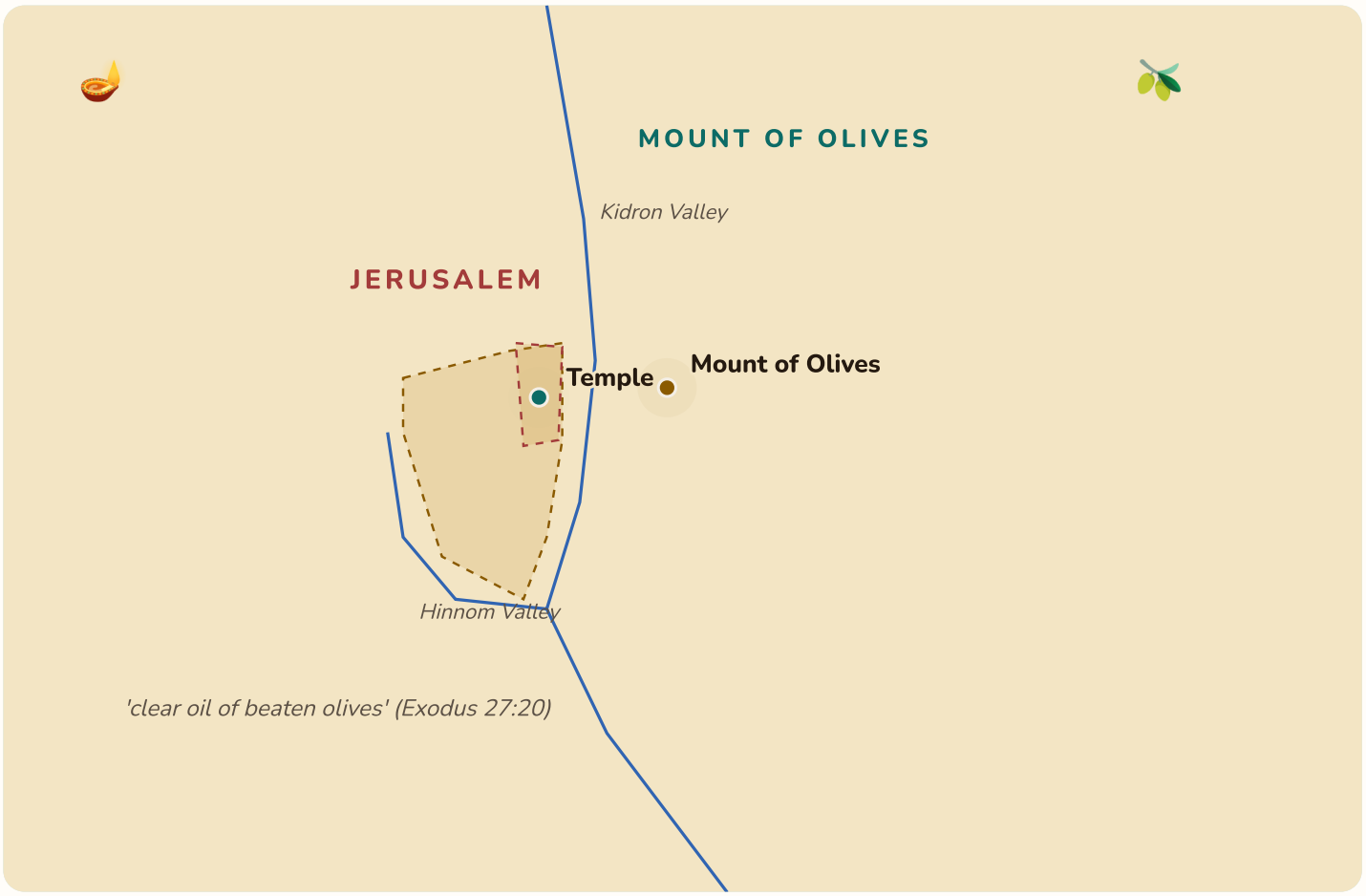
BACKGROUND They tended it 'from evening to morning' (Exodus 27:21).

Exodus 27:21 · ◆ Aaron · ◆ Priest

07 · BACKGROUND

The temple and its lamp

The pin outlined in the video's color is a place the video points to. Gold pins are background.



● Named in the video ● Background

Schematic: drawn for this study from known sites. Walls (gold dashes) and the temple platform (coral dashes) are approximate for the first century.

Temple VIDEO

The holy place held the golden lampstand; the parables are told about the temple's coming fall.

◆ Factbook: Temple (Jewish) ◆ Factbook: Lampstand

Mount of Olives BACKGROUND

Where Jesus is still teaching (24:3); named for its olive groves, the source of lamp oil.

◆ Factbook: Mount of Olives

08

Key terms

Virgins

VIDEO

Bridesmaids: young unmarried women attending the bride.

◆ Factbook: Marriage

Lamps

VIDEO

Torches or oil lamps carried in the night procession (lampas).

◆ Factbook: Lampstand

Menorah

VIDEO

Talent

VIDEO

The seven-branched golden lampstand kept burning by the priests.

◆ Factbook: Lampstand

◆ Factbook: Lampstand (menorah)

A very large weight of silver; in 25:18, simply 'money.'

◆ Factbook: Talent

Gematria

VIDEO

The video's word for biblical number symbolism (not medieval Kabbalah).

◆ Factbook: Gematria

New covenant

VIDEO

The covenant promised in Jeremiah 31:31-34, pictured as a marriage.

◆ Factbook: New covenant

Outer darkness

VIDEO

The place of 'weeping and gnashing of teeth' (25:30).

◆ Factbook: Outer darkness

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

παρθένος

parthenos G3933

Virgin, young unmarried woman.

Greek · Matt 25:1

λαμπάς

lampas G2985

Torch, lamp.

Greek · Matt 25:1, 8

ἔλαιον

elaion G1637

Olive oil.

Greek · Matt 25:4, 8

νυμφίος

nymphios G3566

Bridegroom.

Greek · Matt 25:1

◆ Factbook: Bridegroom

τάλαντον

talanton G5007

Talent, a weight of silver or gold.

δύναμις

dynamis G1411

Power, ability.

Greek · Matt 25:15

◆ Factbook: Talent

Greek · Matt 25:15

ὀκνηρός

oknēros G3636

Lazy, slothful, hesitant.

Greek · Matt 25:26

מְנוֹרָה

menorah H4501

Lampstand.

Hebrew · Lev 24:4

◆ Factbook: Lampstand

◆ Factbook: Lampstand (menorah)

תָּמִיד

tamid H8548

Continually, regularly. Look up: BDB, תָּמִיד.

Hebrew · Exod 27:20; Lev 24:4

בָּעַל

ba'al H1166

To marry, be husband, be lord over.

Hebrew · Jer 31:32

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Wedding customs

A Jewish wedding often ended with the bridegroom bringing the bride to his home for a feast that could last days. Friends lit the way at night with torches or lamps on poles.

The talent

A talent was a weight, about 6,000 denarii in silver. One talent was roughly twenty years' wages for a day laborer, so even the one-talent slave held a fortune.

Josiah's reform

Josiah (c. 640-609 BC) repaired the temple, and the book of the law was found during the work (2 Kings 22:8). His grandfather Manasseh had filled the temple with idols (2 Kings 21:4-7).

SOURCED **Early witnesses**

> *"But by lamps here, He means the gift itself of virginity, the purity of holiness; and by oil, humanity, almsgiving, succor to them that are in need.*

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 78, on 25:1-13. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *"And if in Luke the parable of the talents is otherwise put, this is to be said, that the one is really different from the other.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 78, on 25:14-30. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED

Where scholars differ

What is the oil?

Chrysostom read it as mercy and almsgiving; others as faith, the Holy Spirit, or good works. The video reads the lamps and oil through the priests' lampstand.

AD 70 or the final coming?

The video reads both parables as pictures of the temple's fall and the disciples' calling afterward. Most interpreters read them as about readiness for Christ's final return.

Numbers as symbols

The video links five to the Torah and ten to Zechariah 8:23. Others read the numbers as simple storytelling: a round ten, split evenly.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- The link between 'five' and the Torah is the video's interpretation; Matthew does not explain the numbers.
- The idea that latecomers would normally have been let in is offered without a source.
- Exodus 27:21 says the lamp was kept 'from evening to morning'; whether it burned day and night is debated.
- The wedding-procession details are from a commentator the video cites; customs varied.
- The video's '24:25' means chapters 24 and 25 together.

11 · BACKGROUND

From the lampstand to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 25:1-30 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

C. 1446 BC DEBATED

The lamp to burn continually

Exodus 27:20-21 *Echoed: 25:1-13*

C. 622 BC DEBATED

Josiah repairs the temple

2 Kings 22:4-7 *Echoed: 25:14-30*

C. 600 BC DEBATED
Jeremiah: 'I was a husband to them'
Jeremiah 31:32

C. 520 BC DEBATED
Zechariah: ten men from the nations
Zechariah 8:23

C. AD 30 DEBATED
The virgins and the talents
Matthew 25:1-30 *This episode*

C. AD 60 DEBATED
Peter: living stones
1 Peter 2:4-6

C. AD 390
Chrysostom: the oil is mercy
Matthew 25:4

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Luke 12:35-38
Keep your lamps lit
ADDED

Revelation 19:7-9
The marriage supper of the Lamb
ADDED

Hosea 2:19-20
I will betroth you to Me
ADDED

1 Corinthians 3:16-17
You are a temple of God
ADDED

Revelation 1:20
The lampstands are the churches
ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1 ☐ What made the foolish virgins foolish?

2 ☐ Why can't the prudent share their oil?

3 ☐ How do weddings picture God's covenant with His people?

4 ☐ What has the master entrusted to you, and what are you doing with it?

5 ☐ Why does the third slave's fear lead him to hide the talent?

6 ☐ How are you helping to keep God's presence 'burning' among His people?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson: the kingdom of heaven will continue to spread even after the Jewish temple is destroyed, because Jesus' disciples will faithfully maintain God's eternal presence with His people and increase the magnitude of His true temple. Others would see the temple's fall as the end of God's presence; the disciples should not, because the true temple lives on in the people of God. Ask yourself: am I maintaining God's presence and increasing the magnitude of His temple?

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

name one 'talent' (time, money, a skill) you have been burying, and one step to put it to work for the kingdom this week.

> *"The kingdom of heaven will continue to spread even after the Jewish temple is destroyed because Jesus' disciples will faithfully maintain God's eternal presence with his people and they will increase the magnitude of his true temple.*
>
> From the video

15

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ Egypt ◆ Isaiah ◆ Wilderness ◆ Holy Spirit ◆ Kingdom of heaven

◆ Temple (Jewish) ◆ Jerusalem ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Almsgiving ◆ Disciples ◆ Ezekiel (prophet)

◆ Jeremiah (prophet) ◆ Lampstand ◆ Law of Moses ◆ Mercy ◆ New covenant ◆ Sermon on the Mount

◆ Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Tabernacle ◆ Valley of Hinnom ◆ Bridegroom ◆ Hosea (the prophet)

◆ Lawlessness ◆ Messianic banquet ◆ Outer darkness ◆ Paul ◆ Priest ◆ Apostle

◆ Micah (the prophet) ◆ Parable ◆ Aaron ◆ Gematria ◆ Denarius ◆ Marriage ◆ Talent

◆ Cornerstone ◆ Idolatry ◆ Mount of Olives ◆ Parable of the wedding banquet ◆ Hilkiah ◆ Josiah

◆ Manasseh (king of Judah) ◆ Lampstand (menorah) ◆ Talents and Minas (Parables)

Source: the video's auto-generated YouTube captions, read in full. Scripture quotations are from the Legacy Standard Bible, copyright 2021 by The Lockman Foundation. All rights reserved. Chrysostom: Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers (public domain). Images: Wikimedia Commons (James Tissot, Brooklyn Museum; Willem de Poorter; public domain). Map: drawn for this study.

Offline copy. Live page: https://shea-nelson.github.io/workout-app/bible/matthew-48/